Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-14

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 6:8-14

8 The Lord God has sworn by Himself, the Lord God of hosts says: "I abhor the pride of Jacob, and hate his palaces; therefore I will deliver up the city and all that is in it."

9 Then it shall come to pass, that if ten men remain in one house, they shall die.

10 And when a relative of the dead, with one who will burn the bodies, picks up the bodies to take them out of the house, he will say to one inside the house, "Are there any more with you?" Then someone will say, "None." And he will say, "Hold your tongue! For we dare not mention the name of the Lord."

11 For behold, the Lord gives a command: He will break the great house into bits, and the little house into pieces.

12 Do horses run on rocks? Does one plow there with oxen? Yet you have turned justice into gall, and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood,

13 You who rejoice over Lo Debar, who say, "Have we not taken Karnaim for ourselves by our own strength?"

14 "But, behold, I will raise up a nation against you, O house of Israel," says the Lord God of hosts; "And they will afflict you from the entrance of Hamath to the Valley of the Arabah."

II. Key Summary

• In verses 8–11, the Lord God swears by Himself that He abhors the pride of Jacob and hates his palaces, and will deliver up the city and all that is in it; if ten men remain in one house, they shall die, and the one gathering the bodies says, "Hold your tongue! For we dare not mention the name of the Lord"; at the Lord's command the great house is broken into bits and the little house into pieces.

• Verse 12 asks, "Do horses run on rocks? Does one plow there with oxen?" and then says that Israel has turned justice into gall and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood.

• In verses 13–14, the people rejoice over Lo Debar and boast that they took Karnaim "by our own strength"; the Lord God of hosts says He will raise up a nation against the house of Israel to afflict them from the entrance of Hamath to the Valley of the Arabah.

III. Passage Analysis

"Yet you have turned justice into gall"

> You can't expect a good result if you run a horse over rough rocks, because the horse will be injured. In the same way, Israel could not expect a good result when they turned justice into gall, and the fruit of righteousness into wormwood. [1]

Verse 12 first asks two questions — do horses run on rocks, does one plow there with oxen? — and then, with the word "yet," says this is exactly the kind of thing Israel has done.

What should have been the fruit of righteousness came out of their hands as wormwood.

"Have we not taken Karnaim for ourselves by our own strength?"

> The Israelites are represented as priding themselves on the power which they had newly acquired under Jeroboam II., and the acquisition of which they attribute to their own exertions. [2]

"Karnaim" carries the meaning of "horns," and the horn is a symbol of strength [3]. In verse 13 they boast that they took it "by our own strength"; in verse 8 God says, "I abhor the pride of Jacob."

They boasted that they had taken Karnaim themselves, but God said, "I will raise up a nation against you" (v. 14).

IV. Reflection Question

Think of something you recently pulled off and felt proud of. Which parts of it came "by your own strength," and which didn't?

Israel boasted, "Have we not taken Karnaim for ourselves by our own strength?" (v. 13); but the LORD said, "I will raise up a nation against you." (v. 14)

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Amos 6, https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/amos-6/

[2] BibleHub, Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges (Amos 6:13), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/6-13.htm

[3] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chuan Zhu Bible Commentary (Amos 6 notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT06.htm